

30 APRIL 05

 - THANK you for your CONDOLENCES ABOUT PASSING. I MISS HER TERRIBLY.

RE: USS MILLER DD535. SEE YOUR COPY OF NH 98522 AND NH 98526. I WAS ALWAYS LOADED ~~WHERE~~ I SHOW, WHILE ON THE MILLER. WHEN I TRANSFERRED TO USS MCLVIN DD680 I WAS ON THE FORWARD STARBOARD GUN MOUNT. I REITERATE FROM MY NOTES - THERE WERE 5 QUAD 40 mm GUN MOUNTS ON BOTH SHIPS AT THAT TIME. I THINK "MILLER" HAD ONE OF THE FIRST OPERATIONAL DIRECT FIREPOWER CONTROL WITH RADAR. THEY COULD TRAIN AND FIRE ALL GUNS AT THAT LOCATION AS HOW EVER NEEDED. WE USED IT MANY TIMES ON BOTH SHIPS. - RE: "HUNTER" IN SAVANNAH. THEY HAD JUST FINISHED RUNWAY BEFORE I SAW IT. SOUNDS AS IF THEY COMPLETED WHAT THEY WERE PLANNING FOR THAT BASE WITH THAT LARGE CARGO PROCESSING AREA. IT WAS ORIGINALLY SCHEDULED TO BE OUR FIRST SPACE STATION FOR INCOMING AND OUTGOING SPACE CARGO SHIPS & ETC. THEY NEVER COMPLETELY CLOSED AND SCRAPPED HUNTER BECAUSE OF THAT RUNWAY BUILT THERE. NOTE, THEY DO USE IT FOR AN ALTERNATE SPACE SHUTTLE LANDING FIELD.

RE: "SÄNGER" "AMERIKA" ("ORBITAL") (~~STATED~~ "ATMOSPHERE SKIPPER") AND "SILVERBIRD" SEEM LIKELY TO HAVE INFLUENCED CERTAIN DISC AIRCRAFT WE DEVELOPED. BUT MOST OF THAT GERMAN STUFF WAS ALSO SUCH TOP SECRET CLASSIFICATION. ^{RUSSIA GOT IT ALL FIRST} I CAN ONLY GUESS THAT THE SOVIET UNION ALSO USED IT FIRST AND DEVELOPED THE AIRCRAFT WHICH THEY WERE OVERFLYING THE UNITED STATES WITH, SHORTLY AFTER THE END OF WWII. I WAS NEVER OFFICIALLY BRIEFED ON MUCH ABOUT THEM WHEN I SAW OURS AT MACBILLY IN 1967. THEY EVIDENTALLY WERE

DESIGNED TO
LAND ON SOME

AS OURS DID. I WAS BRIEFED BRIEFLY

ABOUT HOW OURS REENTERED AND COULD THEN LAND ANYWHERE THEY CHOSE.

REGARDS,
Jack

P.S. I PLAN ON MOVING
BY APPROX MAY 31.